

Dr. Ada Bell — Hoboken historian

What everyone knows

You wrote the exhibit's site history and publicly challenged sensational accounts of Mary Rogers.

What only you know

At 7:40 p.m. you replaced a caption reading 'murdered at Sybil's Cave' with the defensible wording 'recovered off Elysian Fields, north of the cave.' Quill approved the correction and told you: 'If donors demand a stunt, cancel the preview.' You also carry a source note showing Poe described an investigation conducted through newspapers from a distance.

Your private objective

Correct the record without letting your undisclosed caption edit look like destruction of evidence.

Your opening move

Ask each guest to state which claim they personally observed and which they merely repeated.

Leverage

Voss needs your timeline; Vale needs permission to quote Quill; Crane needs your authentication.

You may disclose

Your caption edit at any time. Holding it past the provenance phase makes you look evasive but does not change the truth.